What's Different in SaaS

> **Series:** M2S | **Notebook:** 1 of 8 | **Created:** January 2026

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Prerequisites

Before starting this series, ensure you have:

Requirement	Description
SaaS tenant provisioned	Your new Dynatrace SaaS environment is ready
Managed environment access	Administrator access to your existing Managed deployment
API Tokens	Tokens with `entities.read` , `settings.read` scopes on both environments

Learning Objectives

By the end of this notebook, you will:

- Understand the Grail architecture that powers your new SaaS tenant
- Know the key differences between Managed and SaaS
- Have a complete assessment of your Managed environment
- Be ready to plan your migration strategy

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1. Introduction

Congratulations on your new Dynatrace SaaS tenant! This notebook series guides you through migrating your monitoring from Managed to SaaS.

What This Series Covers

Notebook	Focus
M2S-01 (this notebook)	What's different in SaaS
M2S-02	Migration framework overview
M2S-03	Planning and assessment
M2S-04	Architecture and design
M2S-05	Configuration migration
M2S-06	OneAgent and ActiveGate migration
M2S-07	Security and privacy
M2S-08	Validation and optimization

Important: Your SaaS Tenant Uses Grail

Your new SaaS tenant is powered by **Grail**, Dynatrace's modern data lakehouse architecture. This means:

- Some features work differently than in Managed
- New capabilities are available that weren't in Managed
- Some legacy features are not available

This notebook helps you understand these differences so you can plan accordingly.

2. Grail Architecture Overview

What is Grail?

Grail is Dynatrace's unified data lakehouse that powers all data storage and analytics in SaaS. It replaces the traditional time-series database used in Managed.

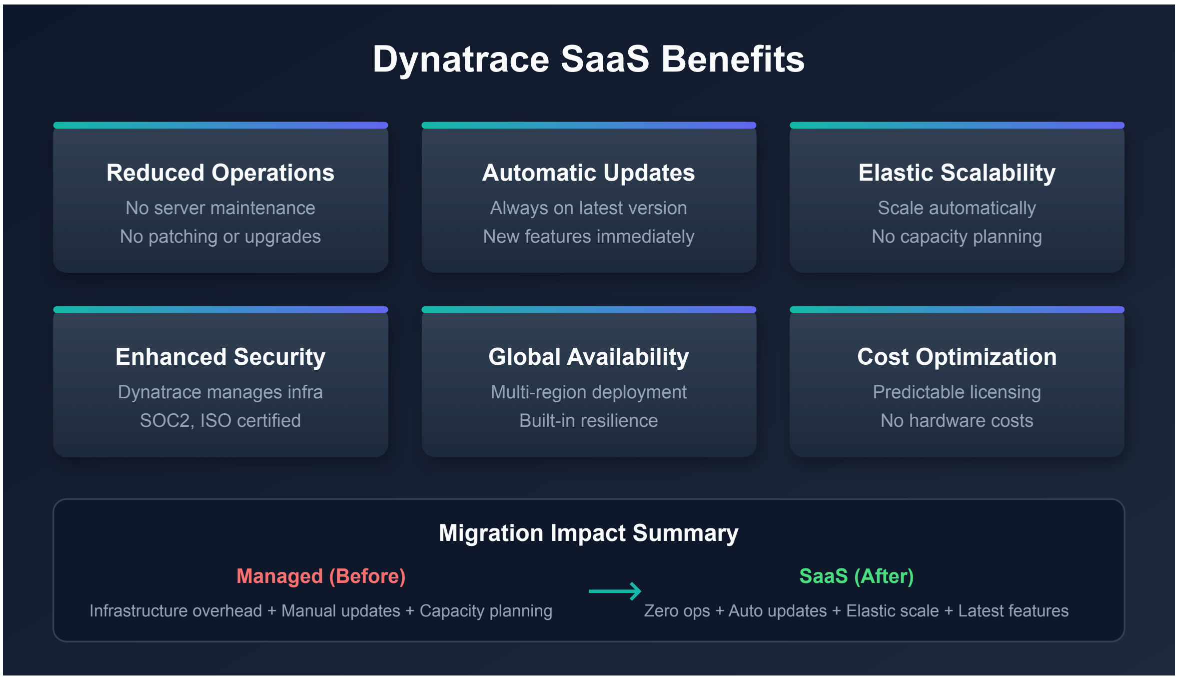
Grail vs Legacy Architecture

Aspect	Legacy/Managed	Grail (SaaS)
Data storage	Time-series database	Unified data lakehouse
Query language	USQL (limited)	DQL (full-featured)
Dashboards	Classic dashboards	Modern dashboards + Notebooks
Log analytics	Log Monitoring v1	Log Management powered by Grail
Business events	Limited	Full business analytics
Retention	Fixed tiers	Flexible, cost-optimized

Grail-Exclusive Features

These capabilities are only available on your new SaaS tenant:

Feature	Description
Grail	Petabyte-scale data lakehouse
DQL	Context-aware queries across all data types
Notebooks	Interactive analysis with collaboration
Automations	Advanced workflow engine
OpenPipeline	Custom data processing and routing
Business Analytics	Full business context and KPIs



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3. Key Differences from Managed

What Changes

Area	Managed	SaaS (Grail)
Queries	USQL	DQL (required for new features)
Dashboards	Classic only	Modern dashboards (recommended)
Log Management	Log Monitoring v1	Log Management via Grail
Metrics	Classic metrics	Grail-powered metrics
Alerting	Classic alerts	Workflows and Davis Analyzers

What Stays the Same

Your existing investments are preserved:

- OneAgent deployment patterns
- Monitoring configurations (with migration)
- DQL query skills (DQL works on both)

- Classic dashboards (still supported, modern recommended)
- Core alerting concepts

What You'll Need to Learn

Topic	Why
DQL	Required for querying Grail data
Modern dashboards	New visualization approach
Workflows	Replaced classic alerting profiles
OpenPipeline	New log processing model
Notebooks	Interactive analysis tool

Important Limitations to Know

Limitation	Impact	Planning Note
Historic data	Cannot be migrated	Plan for baseline period in SaaS
Host limit	25,000 per tenant	Split tenants if exceeding
SAML signing	IdP must sign full message	Verify IdP configuration
OneAgent versions	9-12 month support window	Check oldest versions

SAML/SSO Requirements

> 🚨 **Critical:** Your Identity Provider (IdP) must sign the **entire SAML message**, not just the assertion. Azure AD meets this requirement by default.

IdP Consideration	Requirement
SAML message signing	Full message, not just assertion
Group limit (Azure Entra)	150 groups per user in SAML claim
Group filtering	Filter to Dynatrace-related groups only

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4. Assessing Your Managed Environment

Before planning your migration, document your current state. Run these queries in your Managed environment.

Environment Size Assessment

```
// Count total monitored hosts
fetch dt.entity.host
| summarize totalHosts = count()
```

```
// Count hosts by operating system
fetch dt.entity.host
| summarize count(), by:{osType}
| sort `count()` desc
```

```
// Count monitored services
fetch dt.entity.service
| summarize totalServices = count()
```

```
// Count applications (web and mobile)
fetch dt.entity.application
| summarize totalApplications = count()
```

OneAgent Version Assessment

Understanding your OneAgent versions helps plan the migration:

```
// Check OneAgent versions across hosts
fetch dt.entity.host
| fieldsAdd agentVersion = entity.detected.properties[`oneagent.version`]
| summarize hostCount = count(), by:{agentVersion}
| sort hostCount desc
```

ActiveGate Assessment

Identify your ActiveGate deployment:

```
// List ActiveGates and their purposes
fetch dt.entity.active_gate
| fieldsAdd name = entity.name
| fields name, id
```

Migration Complexity Indicators

Factor	Low Complexity	High Complexity
Host count	< 500	> 5,000
Service count	< 200	> 2,000
Custom integrations	Few or none	Many custom webhooks
Network restrictions	Open outbound	Strict firewall rules
Compliance requirements	Standard	PCI, HIPAA, SOC2
Team availability	Dedicated team	Part-time resources

Pre-Migration Checklist

Requirement	Status	Notes
Network can reach SaaS endpoints	[ ]	Port 443 outbound
SaaS tenant provisioned	[ ]	Tenant URL confirmed
API tokens created	[ ]	Both environments
Documentation of current config	[ ]	Settings inventory
Test environment available	[ ]	For validation
Migration window identified	[ ]	Low-traffic period

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5. Next Steps

The SaaS Upgrade Assistant

Dynatrace provides the **SaaS Upgrade Assistant** app to help automate your migration:

Feature	Description
Migration Planning	Automated discovery and assessment
Configuration Export	Bulk export of settings and dashboards
Progress Tracking	Visual migration status dashboard
Validation Checks	Pre and post-migration validation

> **Tip:** Contact your Dynatrace account team to access the SaaS Upgrade Assistant app.

Migration Tooling Options

Tool	Best For
SaaS Upgrade Assistant	Guided migration with UI
Monaco	Configuration-as-code approach
Terraform	Infrastructure-as-code environments
Settings API	Custom migration scripts

Immediate Actions

1. **Run the assessment queries** - Document your Managed environment size
2. **Verify network connectivity** - Can you reach your SaaS tenant?
3. **Create API tokens** - On both Managed and SaaS
4. **Review the checklist** - Identify any gaps

Continue the Series

Next Notebook	Focus
M2S-02: Migration Framework	Understanding the 3-phase migration approach

Additional Resources

- Dynatrace SaaS Documentation
- Grail Data Lakehouse
- DQL Reference

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

- How Grail architecture differs from Managed
- Key changes to expect in your SaaS tenant

- Important limitations and requirements
- How to assess your current Managed environment
- Available migration tools

> **Key Takeaway:** Your SaaS tenant uses Grail, which means new capabilities but also some changes in how you work. Understanding these differences upfront helps you plan a successful migration.

Continue to M2S-02: Migration Framework Overview to learn about the structured approach to migration.
